

EVIDENCE LOG

For Shoulder Conditions (Limitation of Motion) VA Disability Claims

THE SMOKING GUN EVIDENCE

After years of navigating the VA claims process—as veterans ourselves—we discovered something that changes everything: **the single most powerful piece of evidence you can submit isn't officially part of a Fully Developed Claim.**

"No more convincing. Just corroboration."

When you walk into a C&P exam without this documentation, the examiner's job is to **investigate whether your condition exists and how severe it is.** They're playing detective. You're trying to convince them.

When you walk in WITH a properly completed Evidence Log, the dynamic completely shifts. The examiner's job becomes **corroborating what you've already documented.** They're not investigating—they're verifying. That's a fundamentally different exam.

HOW VA RATERS ACTUALLY EVALUATE YOUR CLAIM

Every VA disability rating—regardless of condition—is based on three core factors. Raters are trained to look for evidence of these specific elements:

FACTOR	WHAT IT MEANS	WHAT RATERS LOOK FOR
FREQUENCY	How often do your symptoms occur?	Daily? Weekly? Constant? with specific triggers?
SEVERITY	How intense are your symptoms when they occur?	Pain levels (1-10)? Range of Motion loss? Duration?
FUNCTIONAL IMPACT	How do symptoms affect your daily life?	Can't work? Can't sleep? Can't lift kids? Missed events?

Why This Evidence Log Works: The template you're about to use is specifically designed to capture all three factors in a format that's easy for raters to process. When a rater opens your file and sees 30 days of documented symptoms with frequency, severity, and functional impact clearly recorded, they don't have to guess or interpret. The evidence speaks for itself.

DO NOT FILE ANY CLAIM UNTIL THIS LOG IS COMPLETED AND INCLUDED WITH YOUR SUBMISSION

SHOULDER CONDITIONS: CONDITION-SPECIFIC GUIDANCE

Shoulder ratings are heavily dependent on ****Range of Motion (ROM)****—specifically how high you can raise your arm (Flexion/Abduction) and **Painful Motion**.

What to Log:

- **Overhead Reach:** Can you wash your hair? Reach a high shelf?
- **Painful Arc:** At what point does the pain start when lifting your arm?
- **Weakness:** Dropping items?
- **Sleep:** Does rolling onto the shoulder wake you up?

Rating Criteria:

RATING	LIMITATION
20%	Motion limited to shoulder level (90°).
30%	Motion limited to midway between side and shoulder level.
40%	Severe limitation (25° from side).

COMPLETED EXAMPLE: 7-DAY EVIDENCE LOG

Below is an example of a properly completed Evidence Log.

DATE	TIME	SYMPTOMS & SEVERITY	FUNCTIONAL IMPACT
Mon 1/6	0700	Sharp pain 7/10 when reaching for coffee cup. "Catching" sensation.	Dropped mug. Used left hand to dress myself.
Tue 1/7	Night	Deep ache 5/10. Woke up 3 times due to pain when turning.	Fatigue all day due to poor sleep. Irritable at work.

YOUR EVIDENCE LOG: 30-DAY TEMPLATE

Instructions: Complete one row per day for at least 30 consecutive days.

VETERAN NAME: _____ **CLAIM #:** _____
_____ **CONDITION:** Shoulder Conditions (Limitation of Motion)
(DC 5201) **START DATE:** _____

DATE	TIME	SYMPTOMS & SEVERITY	FUNCTIONAL IMPACT
Day 1			
Day 2			
Day 3			
...			
Day 30			

Note: Print this page multiple times to cover 30 days.